

Running the `django-admin startproject` command creates a skeleton of your project. The new RiffMates project directory looks like this:

```
RiffMates/
├── RiffMates
│   ├── __init__.py
│   ├── asgi.py
│   ├── settings.py
│   ├── urls.py
│   └── wsgi.py
└── manage.py
```

The project directory (RiffMates) contains the confusingly named configuration directory (RiffMates/RiffMates), the virtual environment, and the `manage.py` command. The `manage.py` command does pretty much the same things as `django-admin`, except it is connected to, and aware of, your project.

The RiffMates/RiffMates configuration directory contains the previously mentioned `wsgi.py` and `urls.py` files, along with a few others. Your project is a Python program, so the configuration directory is a module, meaning it contains an `__init__.py` file.

The `asgi.py` file is an asynchronous version of WSGI. Depending on the kind of web server you're using, you might point to `asgi.py` instead of `wsgi.py`. More details on when these two files get used is covered in appendix B.

The final file in the configuration directory is `settings.py`; it contains configuration values for changing the behavior of Django. (We'll have more on that in a bit.)

You've created your first Django project, and now, you actually have a website! Albeit, it's a very small, rather boring website, but it exists. You haven't built any pages yet, but Django provides a default one for you, and it has a fancy rocket ship on it! To see the website and bask in the glory of the rocket ship, you need a web server. Django ships with one, and when you're developing your site, this is the server to use.

You start the Django development server using the `manage.py` script and the `runserver` command. Note that you do this inside the RiffMates project directory, not the RiffMates/RiffMates configuration directory! Start the Django development server by running the following command:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py runserver
```

Type less on Unix

Throughout this book, when it is time to run a Django management command, the instructions are to type `python manage.py`, as this is compatible across all operating systems. On Unix systems, including Linux and macOS, `manage.py` is executable, so you can use `./` execution. For example, the development server command gets shortened to the following:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ ./manage.py runserver
```

There are a number of management commands you'll be using frequently, so you may want to add tab completion to your shell. On bash, run the following (or add it to your `.bash_profile` or `.bash_rc` file):